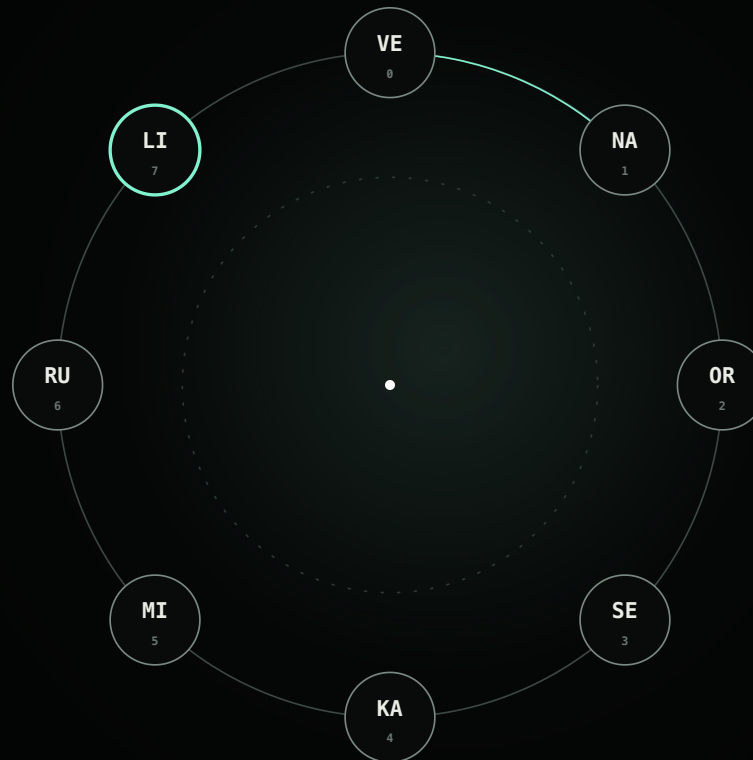


RULESET

THE QUICK GUIDE

UNDERSTAND THE GAME IN 15 MINUTES
CORE IDEA • ECHO • FINALE
INTERNAL / FULL SPOILERS

PROGRESS / 21



DRAG ME

LEVEL 35 / SE

Everything is part of the puzzle.

The Game at a Glance

START HERE

RULESET teaches you that anything on screen can be used.

Words. Buttons. Time. Windows. Progress. Memory. Even the instruction itself.

The core idea	03
Season I - break the interface	04
Season II - learn ECHO	07
The final month-long puzzle	16

01 Notice what the game quietly permits.

02 Learn a rule through a simple action.

03 Reuse that rule somewhere unexpected.

04 Combine old knowledge into a new solution.

The puzzle is not only inside the game window.

The whole interface is the puzzle surface.

RULESET is not about obscure knowledge or fast reflexes. It is about interpretation: learning what actions exist, then recognizing when those actions apply somewhere new.

THE DESIRED FEELING

“WAIT...
I CAN DO THAT?”

“Of course.
That makes perfect sense.”

The Puzzle Promise

THE SHORT VERSION

The game may misdirect your attention. It may never contradict its own rules.

01

Every puzzle has a logical solution.

02

You always receive enough information.

03

Surprise is welcome. Randomness is not.

04

No pixel hunting or pure guessing.

05

Old mechanics return only in new contexts.

06

The best answer is simple after you see it.

EACH SOLUTION TEACHES THE NEXT ONE.

Two Learning Phases

LEVELS 1-45

LEVELS 1-15

BREAK THE RULE

I

Words can be dragged.

Numbers can be resized.

A timer can be defeated.

Doing nothing can be correct.

The window and global UI can participate.

LEARN WHAT CAN BE TOUCHED



LEVELS 16-45 / ECHO

LEARN TO READ

II

Eight tokens gain meanings.

The tokens also become numbers.

Pairs become characters.

Messages can be rotated.

The whole month becomes one puzzle.

LEARN WHAT INFORMATION CAN BECOME

Season I / Six Examples

CONCEPTUAL MOCKUPS

01 / DRAG THE WORD

DRAG THE SQUARE



Words are objects.

02 / MAKE 5 BIGGER

5 > 10



Size changes meaning.

03 / REMOVE RED

PRESS ~~RED~~ BLUE



Instructions can be edited.

04 / DO NOTHING

DO NOT TOUCH



Inaction is input.

05 / RESIZE WINDOW

↔ VIEWPORT ↔



The frame is a control.

06 / YOU CANNOT FINISH

YOU CANNOT FINISH



The claim can be manipulated.

YOU ARE READY TO READ.

AFTER LEVEL 15 / BLACK SCREEN / SILENCE

How ECHO Grows

WORDS BECOME A SYSTEM

The player thinks they are learning a tiny language. That is true - but incomplete.

01

WORDS

Each token is taught through a physical action.

VE = MOVE

02

SENTENCES

Known words combine into clear instructions.

VE NA OR

03

POSITIONS

The same words become numbered locations on a ring.

VE = 0

04

DATA

Token pairs become characters; rotation hides and restores messages.

YOU BUILT THE KEY

The Eight ECHO Tokens

MEANING + INDEX

VE

0

MOVE

Move an object.

NA

1

THIS / TARGET

Identify the current target.

OR

2

LEFT

Choose the left side.

SE

3

RIGHT

Choose the right side.

KA

4

NOT

Negate the next action.

MI

5

ONE

Perform exactly once.

RU

6

REPEAT

Repeat a shown action.

LI

7

REVEAL

Expose hidden information.

Reading ECHO Sentences

PLAIN LANGUAGE FIRST

A sentence is usually: optional modifier, action, target, optional direction, optional count.



VE NA

Move this.

VE NA OR

Move this left.

KA VE NA

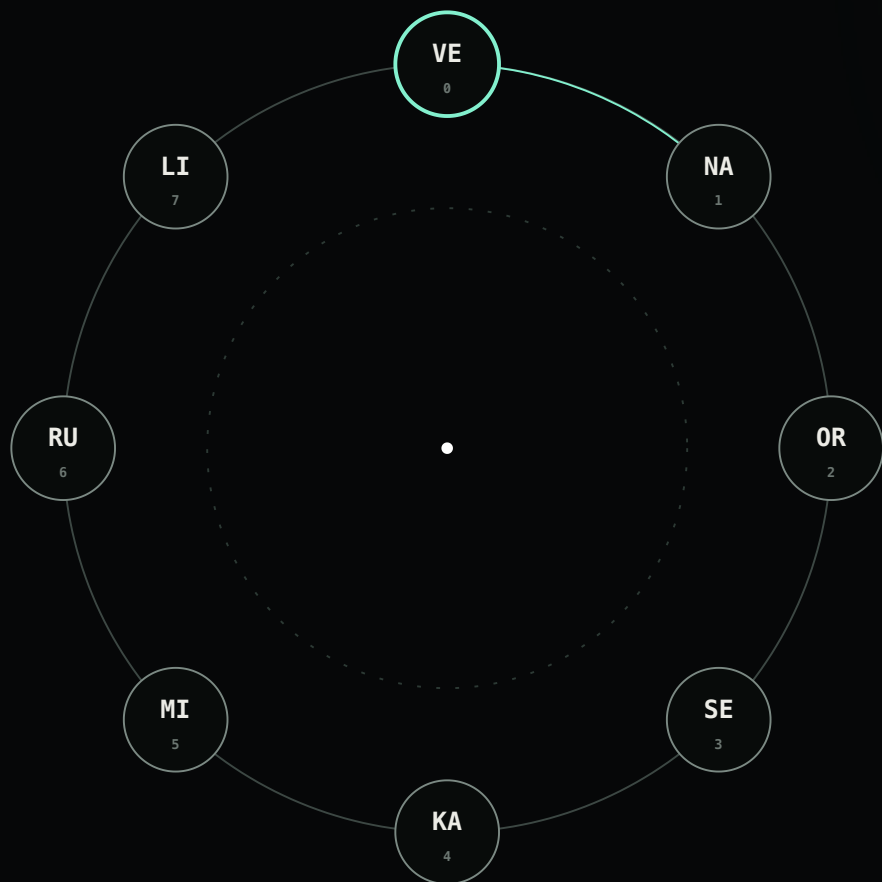
Do not move this.

LI NA

Reveal this.

The ECHO Ring

THE BIG REVEAL



Words become positions.

The eight tokens always have the same clockwise order. Each token now carries both a meaning and a number.

- 1 Learn the token as a word.
- 2 Place it in introduction order.
- 3 Close the line into a ring.
- 4 Use 0-7 as stable coordinates.

VE NA OR SE KA MI RU LI

The ECHO Grid

PAIR = CHARACTER

	VE 0	NA 1	OR 2	SE 3	KA 4	MI 5	RU 6	LI 7
VE 0	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
NA 1	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P
OR 2	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X
SE 3	Y	Z	0	1	2	3	4	5
KA 4	6	7	8	9	[SPACE]	.	,	!
MI 5	?	-	:	;	+	/	(	)
RU 6	[	]	{	}	<	>	@	#
LI 7	%	&	*	_	=	'	"	\$

SIMPLE EXAMPLE

VE + RU

First token = row 0.

Second token = column 6.

= G

Every two-token pair points to one character.

Decode One Message

EXPLICIT PHASE / OPEN

A phase rotates the visible tokens. Decoding simply rotates them backward.

01 PHASE OR = 2 The prefix says every payload token moved forward two places.	02 VISIBLE SE VE SE NA OR RU SE LI This is ciphertext, not meaning.	03 ROTATE BACK -2 -2 -2 -2 Move each token backward around the Ring.	04 NORMALIZED NA RU NA LI VE KA NA MI These are the real Grid coordinates.	05 READ O P E N Now physically open the object.
---	---	--	--	---

$\text{NORMALIZED INDEX} = (\text{VISIBLE INDEX} - \text{PHASE} + 8) \text{ MOD } 8$

Later: The Level Is the Phase

THE INTERFACE BECOMES DATA

After Level 34, the message no longer shows a phase prefix. The current Level number replaces it.

16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23
0 / VE	1 / NA	2 / OR	3 / SE	4 / KA	5 / MI	6 / RU	7 / LI

IMPLICIT PHASE

Level 35 → SE / 3

Calculate $(35 - 16) \bmod 8$. Use phase 3 to decode the payload.

THE LEVEL WAS PART OF THE MESSAGE.

35

CHECKSUM

Readable does not mean authentic.

Add all normalized payload indices, then take mod 8. The resulting token proves whether the message changed.

GAME CIPHER / NOT REAL-WORLD SECURITY



ECHO MEMORY

THE DECORATION WAS DATA

Every Level from 16 to 44 quietly leaves one two-token mark. The game remembers all 29.

ECHO MEMORY

SE VE 16	OR LI 17	KA RU 18	LI LI 19	KA MI 20	LI NA 21	LI RU 22	VE OR 23	OR SE 24	MI MI 25
KA MI 26	SE OR 27	KA VE 28	NA NA 29	LI VE 30	LI SE 31	SE VE 32	MI RU 33	RU RU 34	MI LI 35
RU RU 36	MI NA 37	OR OR 38	VE LI 39	OR SE 40	MI MI 41	SE LI 42	KA NA 43	RU OR 44	

The 30-Day Arc

LEVELS 16-45

				
LEARN TO READ	DISCOVER	BREAK BOUNDARIES	LOOK BACK	FINALE
16-23 eight token meanings	24-33 grammar, Ring, Grid, phase	34-41 UI, Level phase, checksum	42-44 Memory and order	45 ending the month

```
${' '}.repeat(30)}
```

WORDS → NUMBERS → CHARACTERS → MEMORY

Level 45 / The Month Was the Puzzle

COMPLETE SPOILERS

01

ORDER

Sort all marks by source Level.

02

PHASE

Use each Level's implicit phase.

03

NORMALIZE

Rotate every two-token mark backward.

04

GRID

Turn each pair into one character.

05

READ

Join the 29 characters.

THE SECRET MESSAGE

YOU BUILT THE KEY. USE IT NOW

The key is the token order the player reconstructed in Level 26:

VE

NA

OR

SE

KA

MI

RU

LI

YOU CAN READ RULESET NOW.

Why the Finale Is Fair

NO NEW RULES

The finale only asks the player to combine knowledge they already earned.

TOKEN MEANINGS

Learned through direct action.

TOKEN ORDER

Rebuilt in Level 26.

RING + NUMBERS

Made visible before cipher play.

GRID PAIRS

Practiced as coordinates.

PHASE

Decoded and encoded repeatedly.

LEVEL PHASE

Explicitly taught in Level 35.

MEMORY

Revealed and practiced in 42-44.

ORDER

Level 44 states ORDER = LEVEL.

FINALE

Only combines existing knowledge.

QUICK GLOSSARY

Puzzle Surface

Everything the player may manipulate.

Echo Token

One of eight words with a meaning and index.

Echo Ring

The fixed circular token order.

Echo Grid

The 8 x 8 character lookup.

Phase

A rotation from 0 to 7.

Normalization

Rotating backward to restore tokens.

Echo Mark

A stored two-token Level payload.

Echo Memory

The interface that reveals all marks.

Meta Puzzle

A puzzle built across many Levels.

BUT CAN RULESET READ YOU?